

AI Ethics & Disclosure Quick Guide

When to say you used AI, how to say it, and why it matters

AI makes you more capable. That doesn't make disclosure optional. This guide gives you a practical framework — not philosophical hand-wringing — for when and how to be transparent about your use of AI tools.

The Three Questions

Ask these before you share anything AI-assisted:

1 Is this accurate?

Your name is on it. Everything in the output — facts, figures, claims, citations — is now your responsibility. You can't blame the AI. Verify before you share.

Action: Run the Verification Checklist (companion resource) on every piece of AI-assisted work before it leaves your hands.

2 Is this honest?

Would the recipient's trust in this work change if they knew how it was made? If yes, disclose. This isn't about rules — it's about the kind of professional you want to be.

Action: When in doubt, disclose. A quick mention builds more trust than getting caught.

3 Is this something you're proud of?

AI lowers the effort bar. That's a feature, not a license. The question isn't whether you could have done it without AI — it's whether the final product meets your standard.

Action: Read it as if someone else wrote it. Would you accept this quality from a colleague?

When to Disclose

Situation	Disclose?	Why
Academic work	Always	Most institutions have AI policies. Violation can mean failure or expulsion.
Published writing (articles, books, reports)	Always	Readers and publishers expect to know. Industry norms are forming fast.
Client deliverables	Yes, usually	Check your contract. When in doubt, mention it — clients appreciate transparency.
Internal work emails	Optional	Company culture dependent. If your org has a policy, follow it.
Personal brainstorming and planning	No	This is your thinking tool. You don't disclose using a calculator.
Creative work you're selling	Yes	Buyers are making assumptions. Let them make informed ones.
Legal or regulatory filings	Check rules	Regulations are evolving. Verify requirements for your jurisdiction and industry.
Job applications	Context-dependent	Using AI to brainstorm is fine. Submitting an AI-written cover letter as your own voice is risky.

How to Disclose (Without Making It Weird)

Disclosure doesn't need to be a confession. Here are natural ways to say it:

In a document footer or acknowledgments:

"Research assisted by Claude AI. All facts independently verified by the author."

In a casual email:

"I used Claude to help draft this – let me know if anything needs adjusting."

In a presentation:

"I used AI tools to research and structure this deck. The analysis and recommendations are mine."

On published work:

"Written with AI assistance. The author takes full responsibility for accuracy and content."

On a website or creative project:

"Built with Claude AI. Designed and directed by [your name]."

Write Your Personal AI Disclosure Policy

Don't make these decisions case by case — that leads to inconsistency and stress. Write your policy once and follow it. Here's a template:

My AI disclosure policy

e.g., I disclose AI use in all published and client work. For internal work, I mention it when the output is substantive. I always verify facts independently. I never submit AI work as if I wrote every word from scratch.

This resource is a companion to Chapter 10 of [Creating with Claude: A Practical Guide for Everyone](#). The book covers ethics, disclosure, and the creator's responsibility in full. Get the book at marquepublishing.com.